

The folds of togas make good places for actors playing the killers in Julius Caesar to hide their daggers

Cobra, the type of snake with which Cleopatra may have killed herself



Cleopatra with her maid Charmian

LOVE BEFORE DUTY

Antony and Cleopatra is a sequel to *Julius Caesar*. Antony falls out with Caesar's heir, Octavius, when he falls in love with Cleopatra, the beautiful queen of Egypt. Lovestruck, Antony forgets his duties to Rome, and another civil war breaks out. The play ends with the suicide of the lovers. Antony stabs himself, and Cleopatra makes a deadly snake bite her.

1940s
US actress
Katherine
Cornell as Cleopatra

TOGAS OR CLOAKS

Roman citizens dressed in elaborately folded robes called togas, which are now often worn in productions of Shakespeare's Roman plays. But Shakespeare would not have known what a toga was. He based his plays on Sir Thomas North's translations of the Greek writer Plutarch. North describes Romans wearing "mantles" and "cloaks," like courtiers did in Shakespeare's time.

SQUEAKING CLEOPATRA

Miss Darragh played Cleopatra to Jerrold Robertshaw's Antony in this early 20th-century production of Shakespeare's play. Cleopatra is Shakespeare's greatest female role. Witty, clever, and stronger than Antony, she dies imagining her story being performed on stage, with a boy playing her. She says, "I shall see some squeaking Cleopatra boy my greatness."



In ancient Rome, purple was a sign of high rank